Session 6: Prototype brief and usability test

Rapid Prototyping & Web Strategy

Your outcome

Create one complete interactive path for a specific visitor goal, then improve the first confusing step using observed feedback.

Before you begin

Choose one visitor goal and sketch the shortest route to it. Use fictional content and records; decide what the prototype must not collect or do.

Participant details

Name: _____ Cohort: _____
Project / task: _____

Working boundaries

Use fictional or explicitly approved examples. Do not paste private customer, employee, health or financial records into public AI tools. Follow your organization's tool and data rules. Treat outputs as drafts; a person verifies facts and approves external actions.

What to keep

Keep a copy of your inputs, outputs, decisions and revisions. Browser-only drafts may not follow you to another device. Upload the completed resource or share a permitted link through your participant dashboard.

Course coaching

Each cohort participant may request one remote coaching session during the course. Request it inside the platform; your instructor confirms the time. Use the same conversation for time changes.

Lab guide

Follow your instructor or work through these steps using approved tools. A document or manual simulation is acceptable when a connected tool is unavailable; label its status honestly.

Step 1

Define the visitor, one goal, and a three-step journey. Ask the assistant to challenge the scope and identify what can be tested without a full product.

Step 2

Agree on a short plan, then build one interactive path with a primary action and success/error states. Review the result before adding features.

Step 3

Ask someone to complete the task on a phone and with a keyboard. Record the first confusion, make one change, and repeat the test.

Worked example — fictional / illustrative

Fictional example: a community workshop interest form uses sample names only and clearly states that it does not create a real registration. A tester misses the primary button; the team changes its label and placement, then repeats the task.

Try the prompt sheet

Use the companion prompt sheet as a starting point, replace bracketed fields and test the result. It is not a guarantee of accuracy or an instruction to publish anything.

Participant worksheet

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Visitor / one goal / explicit non-goals

_____
_____

Three-step journey and primary action

_____
_____

Success, empty, error and loading states

_____
_____

Prototype link or recorded walkthrough

_____
_____

What is simulated / data not collected

_____
_____

Participant worksheet — continued

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Task instruction given to tester

_____
_____

Observed mobile and keyboard behavior

_____
_____

First confusion / change made / retest result

_____
_____

Real deployment requirements and responsible owner

_____
_____

Test, challenge and improve

Test 1

Success: a visitor completes the intended three-step task without your explanation.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 2

Recovery: an empty required field or invalid input produces a useful error and preserves entered information.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 3

Access: repeat on a phone and with keyboard only. Check labels, focus, readable text and the success message.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Transfer challenge

Give a tester only the task, not instructions for the interface. Observe where they hesitate. Make one change and repeat before adding features.

Review and submit

Mark each criterion ready, needs revision, or not applicable with a reason. An instructor reviews the evidence; completing a worksheet alone does not establish approval or certificate eligibility.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — A shareable link or walkthrough demonstrates one complete task.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — The main action, success state, and error recovery are clear.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — Mobile and keyboard checks are documented.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — A user test records confusion and a resulting improvement.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — Prototype limits and real-data boundaries are visible.

Submission

Submit under Interactive Intake / Prototype Mockup in My work. Include your artifact or permitted link, test evidence and notes about what changed. Save a draft if it is not ready for review.

Feedback and follow-through

Feedback received: _____
Change I made: _____
Evidence retested: _____
My next action / owner / review point: _____